Knowledge organiser (TRACK) — Technique studio tasters

Pathway: TRACK · Week 1 Part 1 · Big question: How do four studio media change the mood and contrast of the same identity motif?

Core studio focus

Family: Identity and studio log

Big question: How do four studio media change the mood and contrast of the same identity motif?

• Test graphite tone, ink wash, dry pastel, and layered collage across a four-panel studio sheet.

• Compare how each medium handles sharp edges, smooth blending, and surface texture.

• Record a clear technical annotation under each panel naming strengths and control tips.

Essential vocabulary

• medium: The specific art material or tool used to make marks.

• gradation: A smooth step-by-step shift from dark tone to light tone.

• wash: Thin ink or paint diluted with water for translucent tone.

• collage: Building an image by cutting, tearing, and layering paper shapes.

• motif: A central visual shape or emblem repeated across studies.

Three-step studio method

Step 1: Sketch the motif lightly in all four panels: I use a light H/2B line to place the same emblem at matching scale in Panels 1 to 4.

Step 2: Apply dry and wet tonal media (Panels 1-3): I build graded pencil tone in Panel 1, diluted ink wash in Panel 2, and blended chalk pastel in Panel 3.

Step 3: Construct the collage trial and annotate (Panel 4): I layer cut and torn tonal paper in Panel 4, then write one control note under each panel.